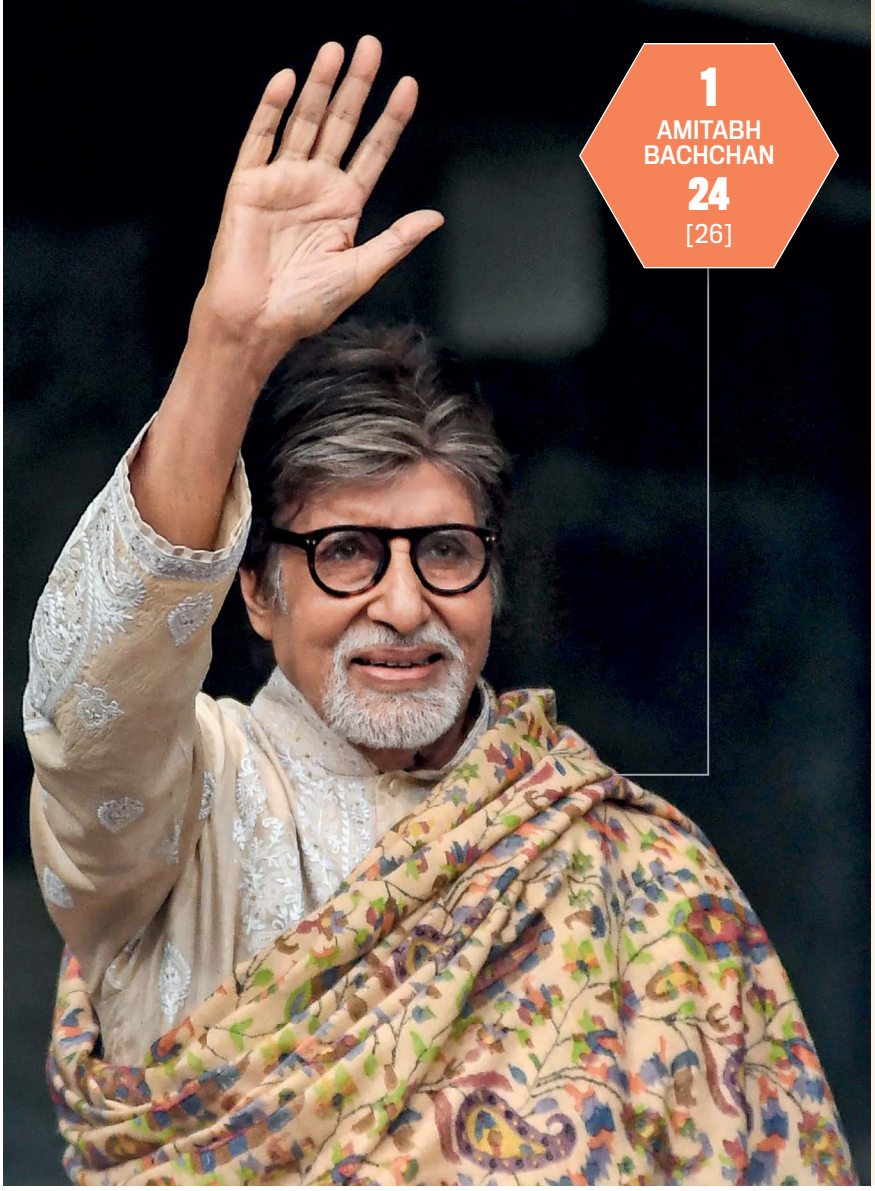


PTI

1 AMITABH BACHCHAN 24 [26]

Q. Who is the No. 1 hero in the country?



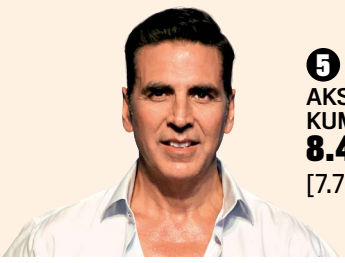
2 SHAH RUKH KHAN 14 [24.5]



3 ALLU ARJUN 8.9 [6]



4 SALMAN KHAN 8.8 [7.9]



5 AKSHAY KUMAR 8.4 [7.7]

MOOD OF THE NATION

ENTERTAINMENT

NEW STARS RISING

***Pushpa* stars Allu Arjun and Rashmika Mandanna emerge at the No. 3 spot in the No. 1 actor/actress stakes, but cannot dislodge the royals—Big B, SRK or Deepika Padukone**

By SUHANI SINGH

Pushpa fire nahin, wildfire hai (Pushpa is not fire, it's wildfire)," says Allu Arjun's character in *Pushpa 2–The Rule*, the highest grossing Indian film of all time. It is no surprise, therefore, to see him rise to No. 3 in the India Today Mood of the Nation poll. Amitabh Bachchan, of course, continues to be the eternal flame that shines the brightest. To reign supreme, the veteran doesn't even need to be as prolific as Akshay Kumar (No. 5) or charm audiences like Shah Rukh Khan (No. 2). The masses are still under the spell of the 82-year-old's cinematic stature. Behind him after a sizeable gap comes Shah Rukh 'Badshah' Khan. SRK didn't have a release last year and